

EKP PREMIUM BRAND PACKAGE

04

Brand Guide

The working identity for Emily Kathryn Photography — built on the existing brand board, refined for the avatars and competitive position.

PREPARED BY NXTLVL DIGITAL
EDITORIAL PORTRAITURE · SOUTH-CENTRAL
VIRGINIA

EMILYKATHRYN.COM
CONFIDENTIAL · FOR CLIENT
REVIEW

ek.

A working brand guide for Emily Kathryn Photography — built to honor the existing identity, tighten what works, expand what's missing, and align every visible decision to the avatars and competitive position from earlier in this package.

How to Use This Guide

This brand guide is for anyone touching the EKP visual or verbal identity — website, social, packaging, print, email. It is paired with the existing Official Brand Board (logo system, palette, typefaces) and supersedes any ad-hoc decisions made elsewhere. When in doubt, defer to the principles in this document over inherited assumptions.

Every choice in this guide is tied back to a *reason* — the avatar it serves, the competitive position it reinforces, or the market behavior it addresses. The principles matter more than the rules.

1. Brand Essence

Editorial portraiture for the people of South-Central Virginia — designed so the senior or family on the other side of the camera walks away feeling like the most confident, recognizable version of themselves.

EKP is not a wedding photographer. Not a school photographer. Not a corporate headshot photographer. EKP is a *portrait studio with a magazine sensibility*, anchored in a specific geography, deliberately limited to two service lines (senior + family) so each one can be done exceptionally.

The work is editorial without being cold. Personal without being precious. Polished without being posed. Premium without being inaccessible. **A magazine that knows your name.**

2. Brand Position

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For high school seniors and families in the Danville-Lynchburg-Smith Mountain Lake corridor who want their portraits to feel like the cover of

a magazine instead of a yearbook page, Emily Kathryn Photography creates a guided, gender-inclusive editorial portrait experience that ends in wall art and albums they'll keep for a generation.

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PRACTICE

- EKP is **not** a value player. EKP is at the upper-boutique tier and grows toward heirloom.
- EKP is **not** the warm-and-soft family photographer. That lane is well-occupied locally. EKP is the *editorial, identity-led* alternative.
- EKP is **not** a one-vertical studio. Senior + family are the two flagship service lines. Branding portraits and SML lifestyle family work are growth lines.
- EKP **is** the only studio in the corridor that markets to senior boys with the same polish as senior girls.
- EKP **is** the studio whose ordering appointment matters as much as the session — because that's where wall art and albums are sold.

THE TWO-BUYER EQUATION

The brand must work simultaneously for:

- **The buyer (Rachel, 47).** Needs to trust the experience, see the value, feel that her daughter is in good hands, and have a clear next step.
- **The influencer (Ella, 17).** Needs the work to look like fashion editorial, the experience to feel like *content*, and the photographer to feel cool.

Every page, post, and email must pass both filters.

3. Brand Pillars

PILLAR	MEANING	HOW IT SHOWS UP
Editorial Eye	Magazine-quality direction in composition, light, styling.	Hero photography, portfolio galleries, type system, layout rhythm.
Confident Calm	The session feels guided, not performed. Reassurance is structural.	Tone of copy, process pages, FAQ language.
Heirloom Permanence	Images deserve to live on a wall, not a phone.	Investment page, product galleries, in-person ordering.
Personal Style		

PILLAR	MEANING	HOW IT SHOWS UP
	The session is shaped around the person, not a template.	Style consult step, outfit guide content, identity-led portfolio organization.
Local Roots	EKP knows this region — the schools, the landmarks, the seasons.	City pages, named locations, recurring senior class identifiers.
Gender-Inclusive	The brand treats senior boys and girls as equal-priority subjects.	Portfolio mix, casting in marketing, copy language.

4. Logo System

The Official Brand Board's logo system stays intact and is the canonical reference.

PRIMARY LOGO — EMILY KATHRYN WORDMARK

Set in a tall, condensed editorial serif (the *Yo Andy* feel) with **PHOTOGRAPHY** in spaced caps Acrom underneath. This is the primary signature on the website header, marketing materials, and most public-facing surfaces.

Use when: the brand is being introduced for the first time, on covers, on the website header, in social bio art, on print collateral.

Do not: - Stretch or compress the wordmark - Place over busy photography without a translucent overlay - Use the wordmark smaller than 90px wide on screen / 1.25in on print

ALTERNATE LOGO — STACKED EMILY / KATHRYN

Stacked wordmark for tall, narrow applications — Instagram post bottoms, square-ratio marketing collateral, sidebars.

SUBMARK — EK. CIRCLE MONOGRAM

Circle frame with **ek.** at center and *Emily Kathryn Photography* arc'd around the inside. Used on social profile icons, watermarks, packaging seals, and as a small accent in layouts.

LOGO CLEAR SPACE AND SIZING

Minimum clear space around any logo lockup = the height of the wordmark's lowercase x-height on all sides. Minimum web size for the primary logo is 90px wide. Minimum print size is 1.25 inches wide.

WEB-SAFE TYPE SUBSTITUTES (PRODUCTION)

Because *Yo Andy* and *Acrom* are not freely web-licensed for production deployment, the digital implementation should use the closest licensable equivalents:

BRAND BOARD REFERENCE	WEB-SAFE SUBSTITUTE (GOOGLE FONTS)	USE
<i>Yo Andy</i> (tall editorial serif)	Italiana or Cormorant Garamond	Display headlines, large titles
<i>Yo Andy</i> alt	DM Serif Display	Editorial subheads
<i>Acrom</i> (geometric sans)	Inter or Manrope	Body, navigation, UI labels

The Brand Board fonts should still be licensed and used for printed collateral and signature pieces.

5. Color System

BRAND PALETTE (LOCKED — BRAND BOARD)

NAME	HEX	RGB	CMYK	ROLE
Black	#000000	0, 0, 0	0, 0, 0, 100	Type, anchors, deep backgrounds
Warm Gold	#C2A36C	194, 163, 108	0, 16, 44, 24	Premium accent, rules, hairlines, buttons
Blush	#DCB6AD	220, 182, 173	0, 17, 21, 14	Feminine warmth, soft backgrounds
Aqua / Mint	#B3D4CD	179, 212, 205	16, 0, 3, 17	Freshness, youth, secondary accent
Soft Gray	#D6D4D4	214, 212, 212	0, 1, 1, 16	Neutral balance, dividers

EXTENDED WORKING PALETTE (NEW, APPROVED)

Three additional values that complete the system for body type, paper, and depth — derived from the brand palette but expand it for digital legibility and print warmth.

NAME	HEX	RGB	ROLE
Ink	#1A1A1A	26, 26, 26	Body type. Softens 100% black for readability.

NAME	HEX	RGB	ROLE
Paper / Cream	#FAF7F2	250, 247, 242	Page background — warmer than pure white, photo-friendly.
Muted	#6B655C	107, 101, 92	Secondary type, captions, metadata.
Soft Rule	#E5DFD3	229, 223, 211	Table dividers, soft section separators.

COLOR DIRECTION

- **Anchor in black + cream.** Black is for type and contrast; cream is the paper. Together they create the editorial base.
- **Gold is the only premium signal.** Don't introduce other metallic-feel accents. Gold rules, gold buttons, gold underlines, gold seals — that is the whole premium language.
- **Blush and Aqua are accent-only.** Never let either dominate a page. Used for tints, subtle backgrounds, and small accents.
- **Avoid all-beige.** All-beige reads like a wedding-photographer template. Black-and-cream with gold is what differentiates EKP from the soft-beige local field.
- **Avoid full-page color blocks of blush or aqua.** They flatten the image work.

ALLOWABLE COMBINATIONS

BACKGROUND	TYPE	ACCENT	USED FOR
Cream #FAF7F2	Ink #1A1A1A	Gold #C2A36C	Default body
Black #000000	Cream #FAF7F2	Gold #C2A36C	Hero, section dividers
Blush #DCB6AD	Ink #1A1A1A	Gold #C2A36C	Small soft callouts
Cream #FAF7F2	Ink #1A1A1A	Aqua #B3D4CD	Senior-Y2K accents only
Soft Gray #D6D4D4	Ink #1A1A1A	—	Quiet utility / forms

WHAT TO NEVER DO WITH COLOR

- Don't use gold for body text — it reads as low-contrast and tired.
- Don't combine blush and aqua at high saturation in the same view.
- Don't introduce purple, navy, terracotta, sage, or other non-palette colors. The palette is the palette.
- Don't put colored text on busy photo backgrounds. Use the dark/cream overlay first.

6. Typography System

TYPE HIERARCHY

LEVEL	TYPEFACE	WEIGHT	SIZE (WEB)	SIZE (PRINT)	USE
Display (D1)	Italiana	Regular	72–120px	56–96pt	Hero titles, magazine-style headlines
Display (D2)	Cormorant Garamond	Regular / Italic	48–72px	36–56pt	Page titles, section openers
Heading (H1)	Cormorant Garamond	Regular	36–48px	28–36pt	Article headings, large UI
Heading (H2)	Cormorant Garamond	Semibold	24–32px	18–24pt	Subsections
Eyebrow	Inter	500 weight, all-caps, 0.3em letter-spacing	11–13px	9–11pt	Section labels, eyebrows
Body	Inter	Regular	16–18px	10–11pt	All body type
Caption	Inter	Regular, italic optional	12–14px	8–9pt	Captions, metadata
Quote	Cormorant Garamond Italic	Regular	20–32px	14–18pt	Pull quotes

PAIRING RULES

- **One serif. One sans.** Don't introduce a third typeface.
- **Italiana for display, Cormorant for everything else serif.** Italiana is too narrow for body type but unmatched at large size.
- **Inter for all sans.** No exceptions in production.
- **Italics for emotion, not for emphasis.** Use italics in serif for quotes, captions, and emotional intent. Use semibold (not italics) in sans for emphasis.

LETTER SPACING

- All-caps eyebrows: **0.28–0.42em** letter-spacing. Generous space is the editorial signature.
- Body type: default browser tracking, no manipulation.
- Display serif: slight negative tracking (-0.005 to -0.02em) at very large sizes to tighten editorial composition.

NUMERIC TREATMENT

Numerals — especially in the “01” / “02” / “03” service or section markers — should be set in **Italiana or Cormorant Garamond Regular**, large, gold-accented, and treated as a design element. Lift this directly from magazine layout convention.

7. Photography Direction

The portraits *are* the brand. Type and color frame them; the work has to carry the brand on its own.

AESTHETIC PRINCIPLES

- **Bright but not washed out.** Highlights retained, shadows present.
- **Color-graded consistently.** A single editing voice across an entire gallery — slight warmth, lifted blacks, restrained saturation.
- **Editorial direction, not lifestyle drift.** Subjects are styled, posed with intent, framed deliberately.
- **Confidence over cuteness.** Genuine expression, but the goal is a posture and gaze that reads composed, not silly.
- **Personality-led.** Locations and props tied to the senior's identity (truck, instrument, jersey, FFA jacket, downtown, family farm).
- **Location-rich.** Show range: fields, downtown brick, water, florals, schools, farm, family interiors.

BOYS-INCLUSIVE CASTING

The portfolio currently skews girl-coded. To re-balance:

- Target 30–40% boys in the home page portfolio grid by end of summer 2026
- Senior portfolio page must include a Boys section with at least 18–24 portraits
- Behind-the-scenes social content should feature both with equal frequency
- About page and Process page should reference “seniors” and “the senior” without defaulting to female pronouns

DON'TS

- No over-dark hero crops that hide the subject
- No generic stock-style detail shots (rings, bouquets, isolated outfit props alone)
- No gallery with no organizing principle — galleries must be either chronological, stylistic, or seasonal
- No tiny thumbnails — the work deserves scale on the page
- No filters that age the work (heavy vintage VSCO, soft-glow dreaminess, faded matte presets)

APPROVED EDITING DIRECTION

- Warm-leaning whites, true blacks
- Skin tones natural, no over-smoothing
- Slight warmth in midtones, restrained saturation
- Blacks slightly lifted (matte feel) but never crushed flat
- Color consistency across an entire delivery — *not* a mood-mix

8. Voice & Tone

VOICE ATTRIBUTES (SIX)

ATTRIBUTE	MEANS	DOESN'T MEAN
Warm	Speaks like a trusted friend	Bubbly or overfamiliar
Editorial	Considered, composed sentence rhythm	Cold or distant
Confident	Says what's true, doesn't oversell	Boastful or salesy
Specific	Names the place, the school, the moment	Generic "memories" language
Parent-Clear	A buyer with limited time can read it in 30 seconds	Insider jargon
Senior-Aware	The 17-year-old doesn't feel talked down to	Trying too hard to sound young

VOICE RULES

- 1. Lead with emotion, then support with proof.** Don't bury the feeling under specs.
- 2. Write to the senior and parent together.** If a line only resonates with one, rewrite it.
- 3. Earn the premium price in every paragraph.** Stop writing every time you've written something that could appear on any photographer's website.
- 4. No empty claims.** If you say "magazine-worthy," there has to be a photograph nearby that earns the phrase.
- 5. No participation-trophy adjectives.** Banish *amazing, beautiful (alone), incredible, fabulous, gorgeous*. Use them only when paired with a specific reason.
- 6. Use direct answers in FAQ.** No hedging. The buyer is anxious.
- 7. Avoid the word "capture."** Overused in photography. Use *create, make, photograph, bring out, direct*.

SAMPLE COPY

Hero — Concept A voice (Editorial Heirloom):

Senior portraits that hold up on the wall. Editorial portraiture, made in South-Central Virginia.

Hero — Concept B voice (Modern Muse):

Senior year is the cover. Let's shoot it like one.

Hero — Concept C voice (Boutique Atelier):

A portrait studio for seniors and families, serving the Danville-Lynchburg corridor.

Service section opener:

One subject. One afternoon. A magazine you'll still want to open in twenty years.

Investment section opener:

Sessions begin at \$799. Most families invest between \$1,800 and \$3,500 across digital files, wall art, and a senior album.

About page opener:

Emily Kathryn has photographed seniors and families across South-Central Virginia for over a decade — long enough to know that the right photo doesn't happen by accident.

FAQ — “How much does this cost?”

The session begins at \$799. After your session, we'll meet to design wall art, prints, and an album from your favorite images — most families invest between \$1,800 and \$3,500 in total. We'll send a full investment guide before your session.

Closing CTA:

Let's plan something worth keeping. Inquire for senior + family availability.

WORDS TO USE

Editorial. Designed. Guided. Personal. Confident. Crafted. Considered. Heirloom. Magazine. Studio. Portrait. Frame. Image. Composed. Permanent. Made.

WORDS TO AVOID

Capture (overused). Memories (generic). Amazing. Incredible. Fabulous. Stunning (overused). Best (vague). Top (vague). Quick. Easy. Affordable (off-brand). Cheap. Snap. Click. Pose.

tone across channels

channel	tone	length
Website	Editorial-confident, parent-clear	Tight paragraphs, no walls of text
Instagram caption	Conversational-editorial	2–4 sentences
TikTok caption	Senior-aware, lightly playful	1–2 sentences
Email newsletter	Confident-personal	200–400 words

CHANNEL	tone	LENGTH
Inquiry response	Warm-professional	Personal, addressed by name
Investment guide	Editorial-luxurious	Full sentences, no bullets where possible

9. Layout Principles

WHITESPACE

Whitespace is the most important brand asset after photography. Default toward more than feels comfortable. Editorial layout breathes.

GRID

- Web: 12-column grid with 24px gutter on desktop, 8px on mobile
- Print: 6-column grid, 0.25-inch gutter
- Photography breaks the grid. Type respects the grid.

RHYTHM

A page should alternate: hero photograph → tight type block → image → image-pair → quote → image → CTA. The visual cadence is *photograph, type, breath, photograph*.

PAGE STRUCTURE (WEB)

- Hero: full-bleed image with confident overlay type
- Section 1: Identity / proof
- Section 2: Service routing (Senior / Family)
- Section 3: Pull-quote or editorial statement (black background)
- Section 4: Portfolio grid (no captions)
- Section 5: Process or About teaser
- Section 6: Investment teaser
- Section 7: Inquiry CTA
- Footer: Locations served, NAP, navigation, social

MOBILE CONSIDERATIONS

- Same brand voice, denser visual rhythm
- Hero image scales to 9:16 or 4:5
- Type breaks at appropriate widths — never zoom-required

- 44x44px minimum tap targets
- Sticky inquiry CTA at the bottom of senior + family pages

10. Brand Application Examples

EMAIL SIGNATURE

Emily Kathryn
emily kathryn photography
emilykathryn.com · @emilykathrynphoto
Editorial portraiture · South-Central Virginia

INSTAGRAM BIO

emily kathryn photography
Editorial senior + family portraits · South-Central VA
Danville · Lynchburg · Smith Mountain Lake
Class of 2027 inquiries open ↓

PRINT LETTERHEAD FOOTER

emily kathryn photography
[address line] · [phone] · emilykathryn.com

INQUIRY AUTO-REPLY (SNIPPET)

Hi [Name] –

Thank you for reaching out. I'll personally respond within 48 hours to start planning your session – typically with a few questions about your timing, style direction, and any locations you have in mind.

In the meantime, here's a copy of the EKP Investment Guide [link] so you have a feel for the experience before we talk.

Talk soon,

Emily

11. Launch Checklist

Before any branded surface ships:

- ☐ Logo is exported at minimum 2x retina, with adequate clear space
- ☐ Color values are spec'd from this guide, not eyeballed
- ☐ Type pairing is Italiana/Cormorant + Inter — no third typeface
- ☐ Photography is consistent in editing voice
- ☐ Copy uses the approved word list and avoids the off-brand list
- ☐ Tone is appropriate to the channel
- ☐ Whitespace is generous
- ☐ Boys are visibly represented in any portfolio surface
- ☐ CTAs are inquiry-anchored, not “book now”
- ☐ NAP (name, address, phone) is verified and current

12. Evolution

This guide is meant to be revised at 12 and 24 months as EKP grows into new service lines:

- 12 months: incorporate finalized Personal Branding service line voice
- 24 months: introduce SML lifestyle family vertical sub-system if the vertical scales
- Ongoing: replace placeholder photography with the latest editorial work

The principles do not change. The execution gets sharper.